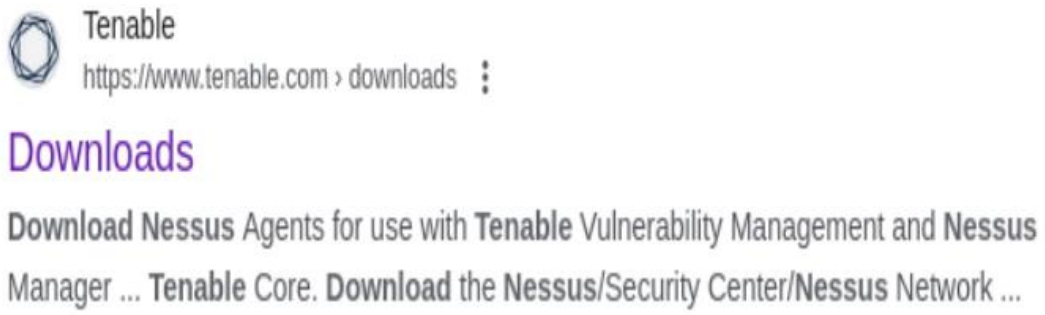
Installing Nessus

Nessus is a vulnerability scanner used by cybersecurity experts to help find vulnerabilities, misconfiguration, default username/password, and much more. If you want to find and patch vulnerabilities that hackers can exploit, familiarizing yourself with Nessus will be extremely helpful. So, in this lab, you'll learn to how install Nessus.

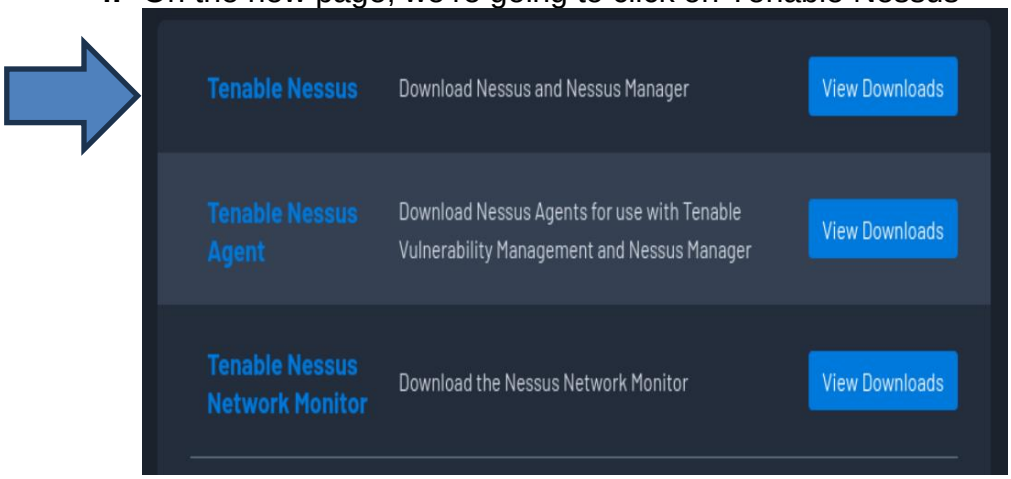
1. Open up your Kali Linux's terminal and make yourself root user.

2. Open up your Web Browser, I'm going to be using Firefox for this lab since it comes with Kali Linux.

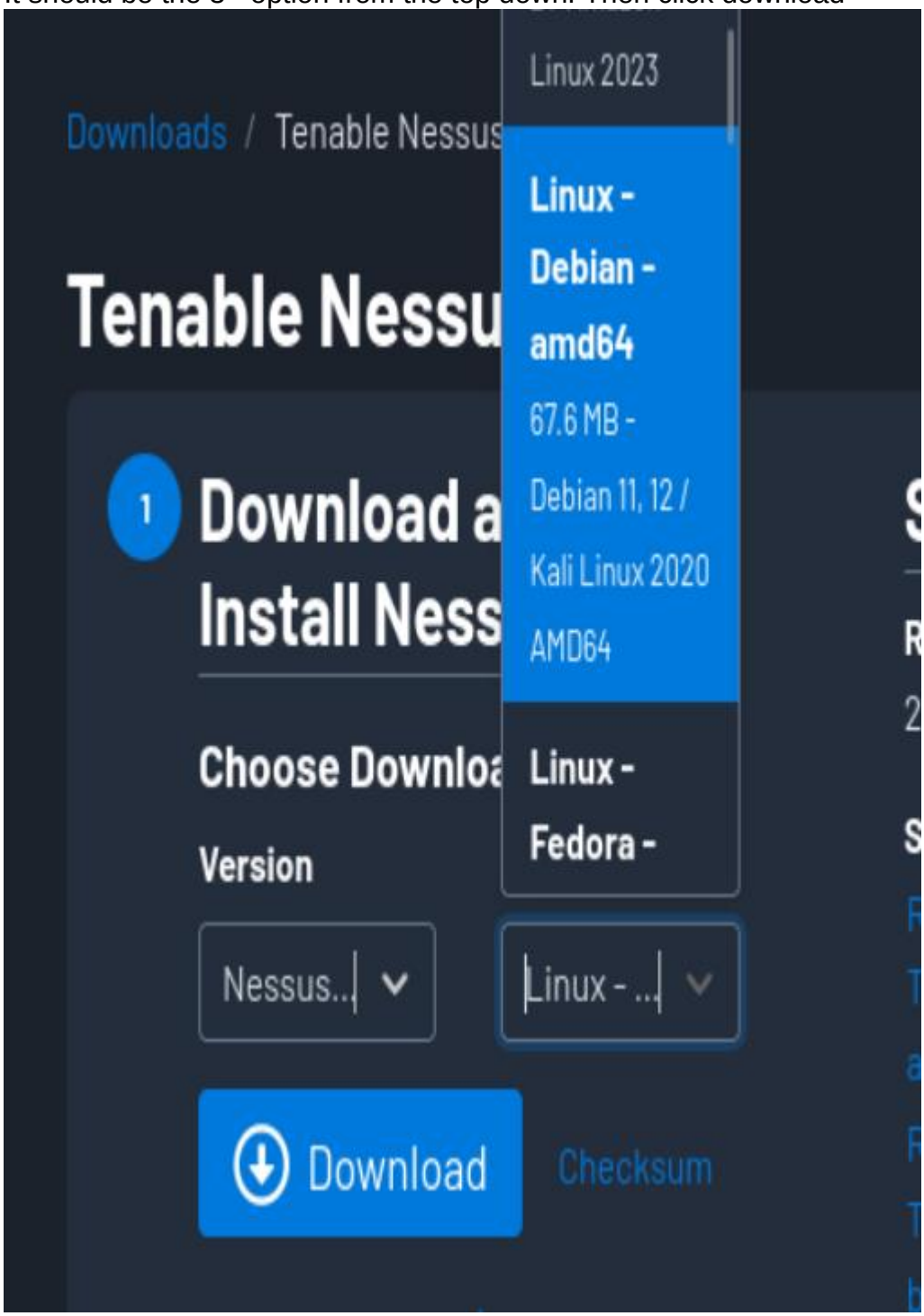
3. Search "nessus essentials download" in google and click on the result that say Tenable



4. On the new page, we're going to click on Tenable Nessus



5. It'll bring you to a new page and on that page we're going to make sure our platform is marked as **"Linux-Debian-amd64"**. Since we're running Kali linux. It should be the 3rd option from the top down. Then click download



6. Click on the file and a window will pop up. Click Agree on the new window.

7. Go back into the terminal navigate to where you downloaded the file. If you didn't change directories it should be in the download directory. Which you can access using **"cd Downloads"**

```
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali]
└─# cd Downloads
```

8. Type “ls” to make sure you saved the Nessus file, if you don’t see it here. Go to your browser and click on show in folder to find where it is. Or if you know how to find files on Linux, you can also use that command.

```
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
└─# ls
Nessus-10.7.5-debian10_amd64.deb
```

9. Install the file using **“dpkg --install Nessus-10.7.5-debian10_amd64.deb”**

```
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
└─# dpkg --install Nessus-10.7.5-debian10_amd64.deb
Selecting previously unselected package nessus.
```

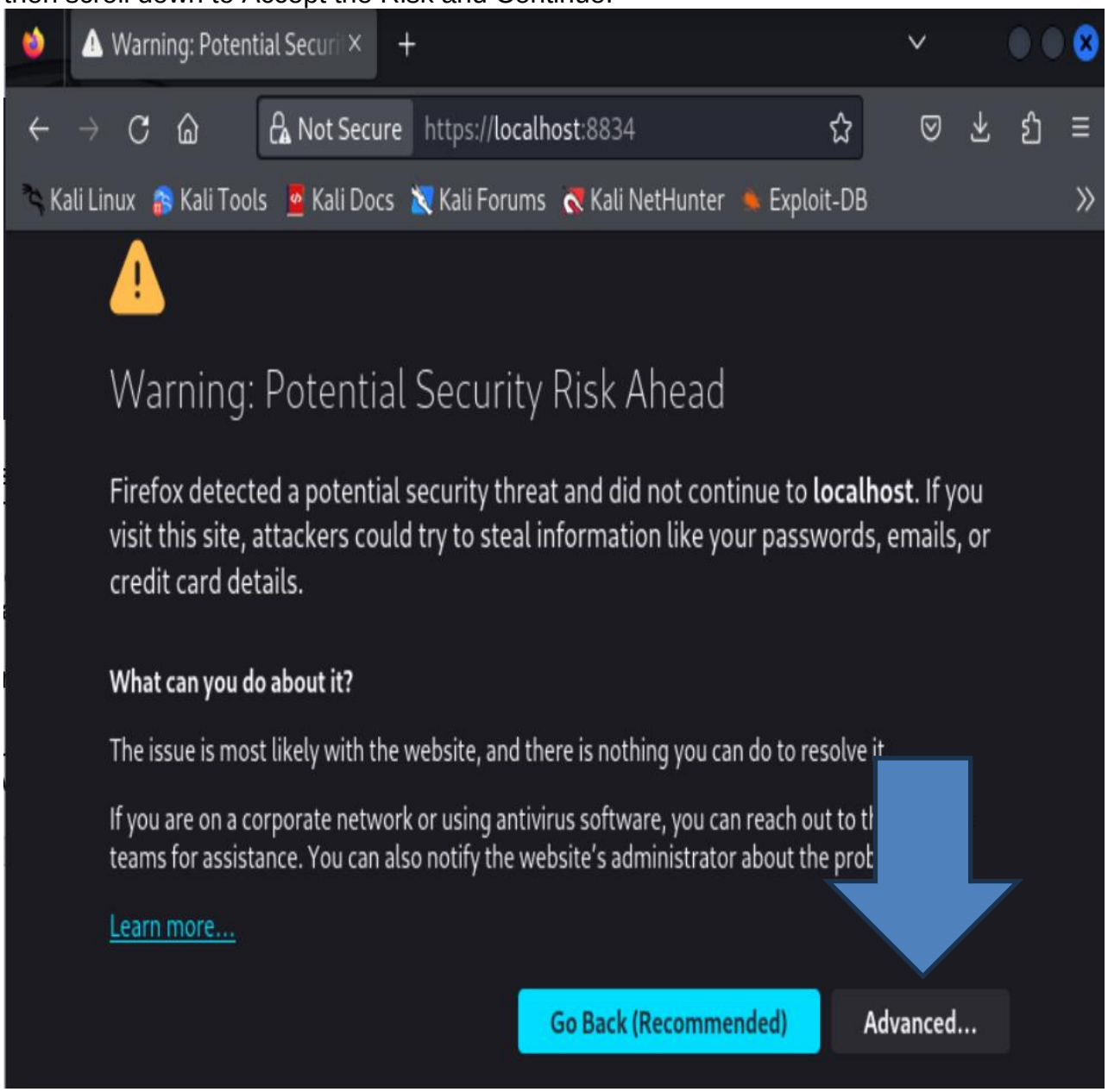
10. Start the Nessus service using the command **“service nessusd start”**

```
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
└─# service nessusd start
```

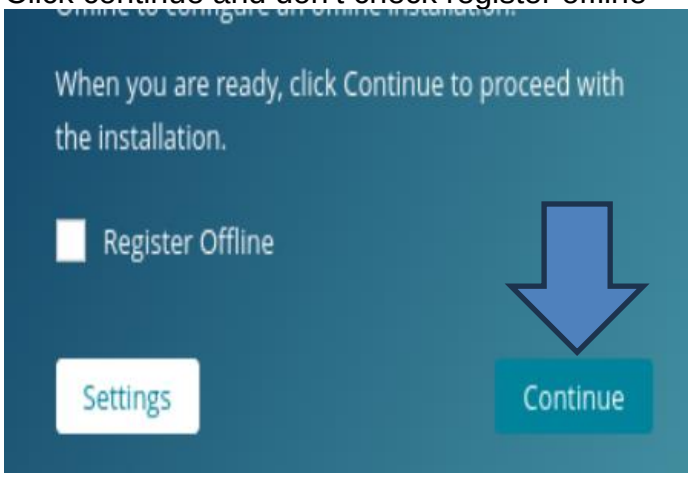
11. Now you want to find out port nessus is operating on so you do “netstat -ap | grep nessus”. Which we can see is port 8834

```
┌──(root㉿kali)-[/home/kali/Downloads]
└─# netstat -ap | grep nessus
tcp        0      0 0.0.0.0:8834    0.0.0.0:*               LISTEN
   20934/nessusd
tcp6       0      0 [::]:8834       [::]:*                  LISTEN
   20934/nessusd
unix  3      [ ]         STREAM     CONNECTED     98788    20925/nessus-servi
c
```

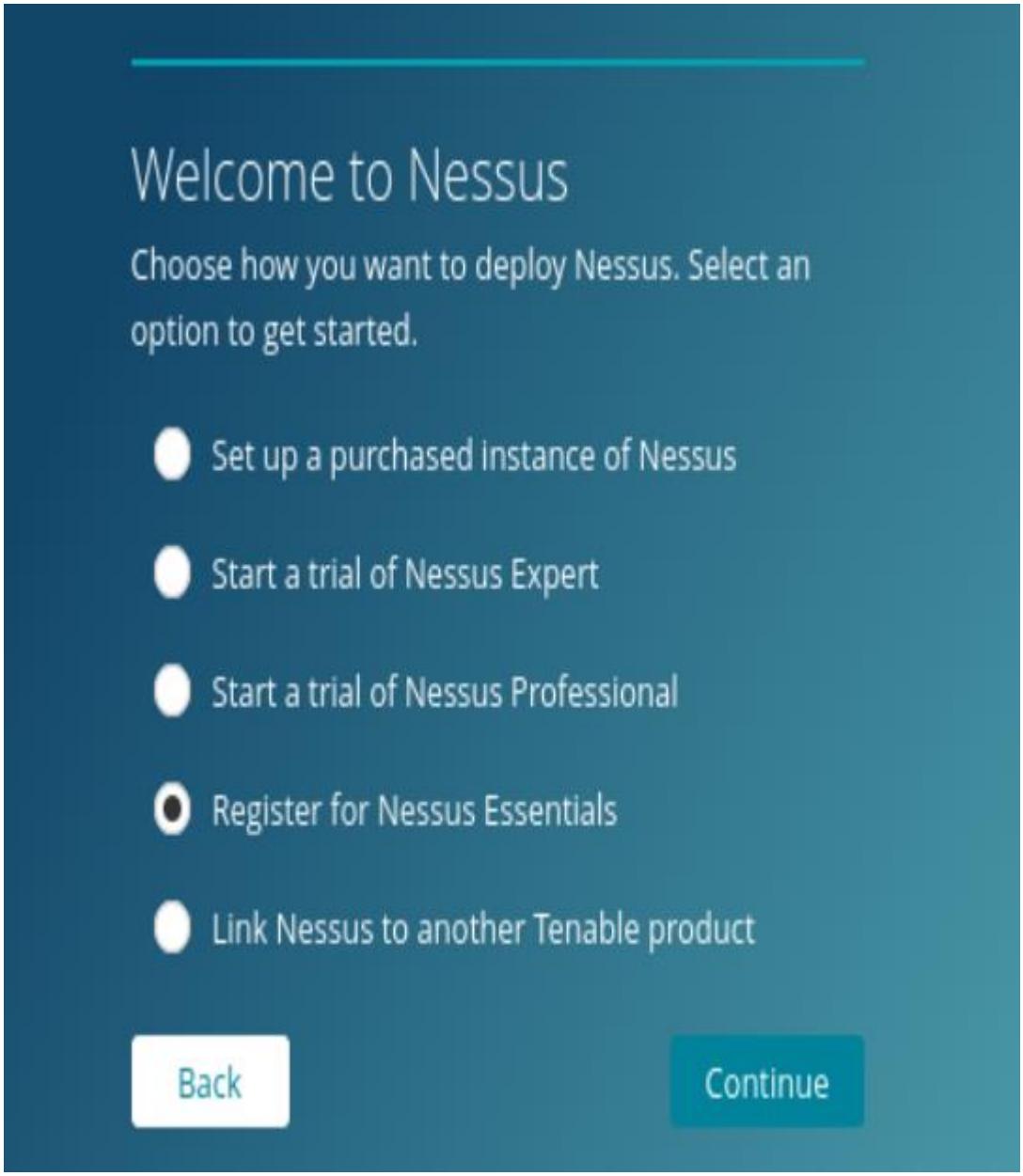
12. Go back to your Firefox browser and use either https://localhost:8834 or https://127.0.0.1:8834. You'll see a warning, don't be scared. Click Advance and then scroll down to Accept the Risk and Continue.



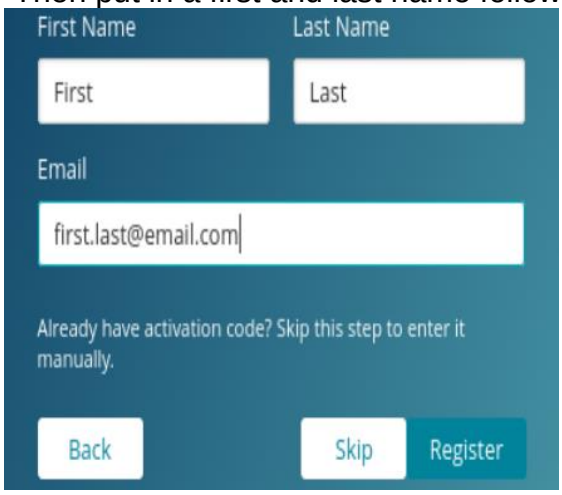
13. Click continue and don't check register offline



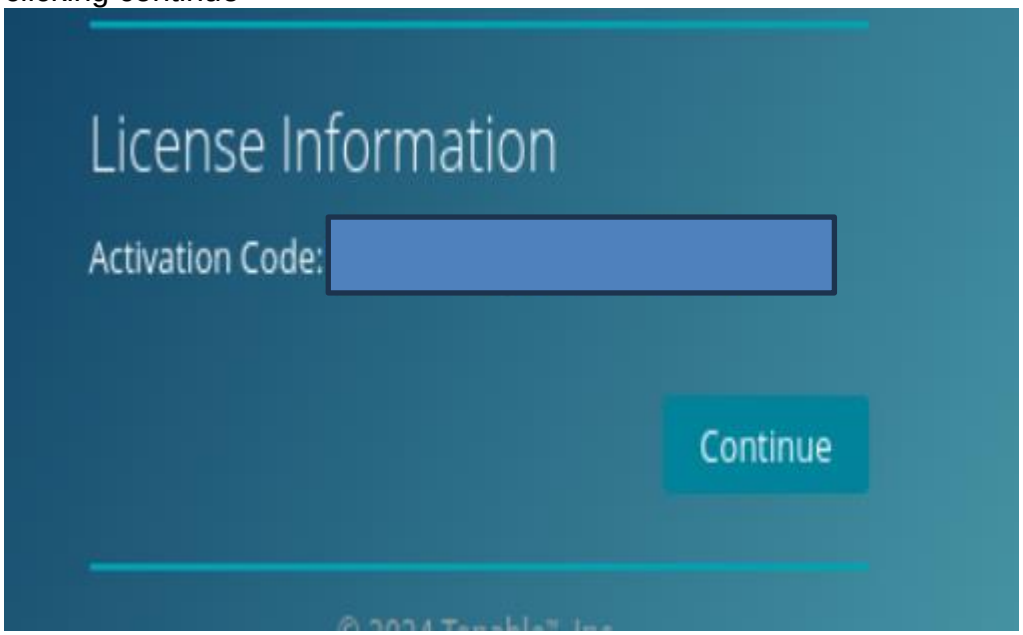
14. On the new page we're going to select the nessus essential options and click continue



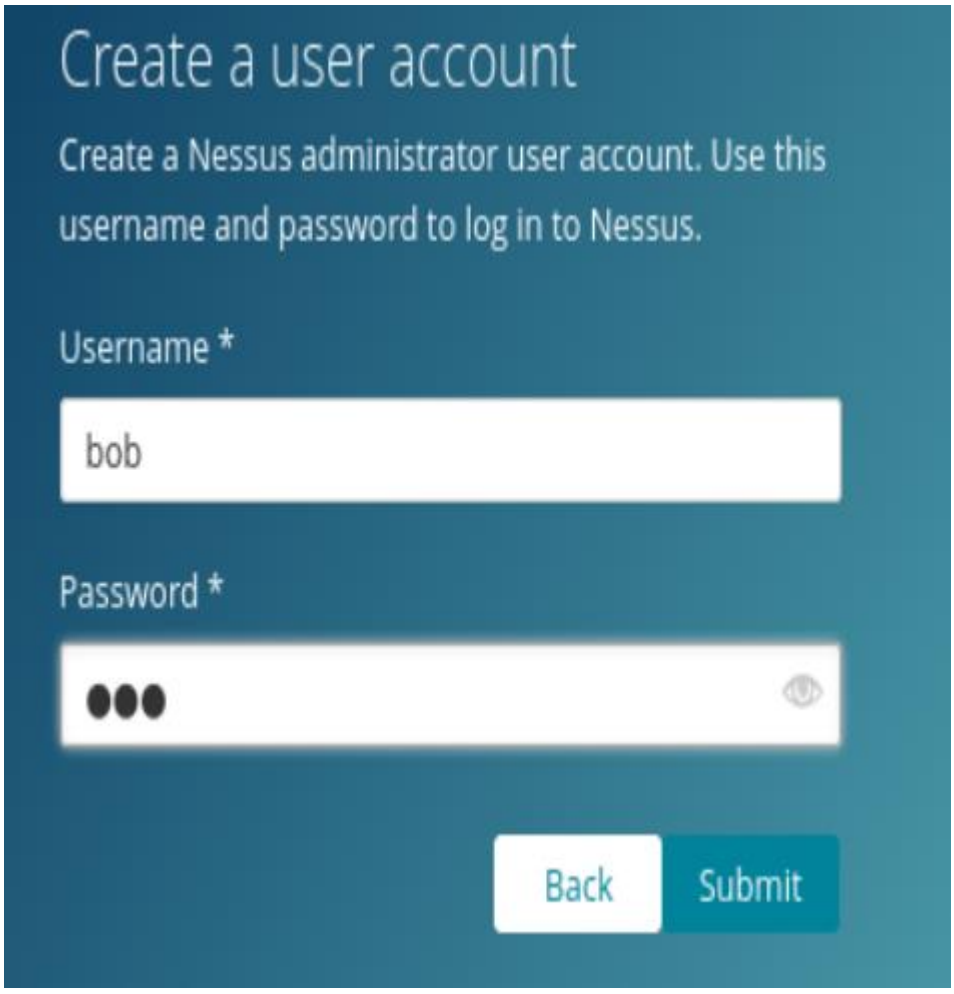
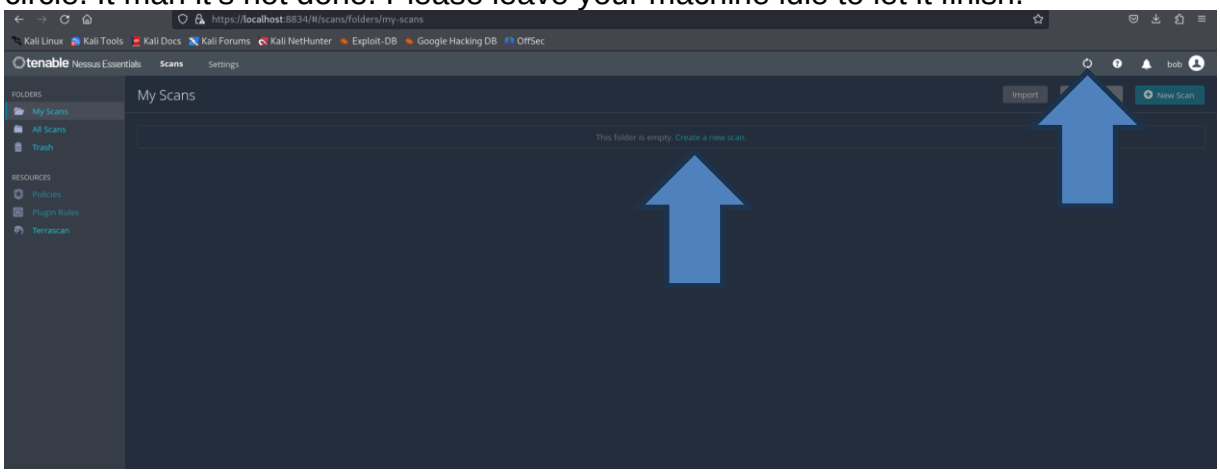
15. Then put in a first and last name followed by an email.



16. It'll then later give you an activation code. I recommend saving this and then clicking continue



17. You will be prompted to create an user account. I recommend for simplicity sake, just use something simple for this lab such as bob for both the user and password and click submit



18. Wait for it to finish initializing the plugins. This can take longer then the bar since the bar just let you access the gui but the plugins aren't 100% initialized yet. If the Create a new scan option isn't doing anything and the top right still has a spinning circle. It man it's not done. Please leave your machine idle to let it finish.